🎯 Goal
In this exercise, you will build a **fully practical automation** that collects leads, stores them, and notifies you automatically.

By the end, you will have a small system that works like a mini CRM.

This is NOT just a simple Zap - it's your first real automation workflow.

🛠️ What You'll Build
A system that:

1. Captures new leads from a form
2. Saves them to a database (Google Sheets or Zapier Tables)
3. Sends you an instant notification
4. Sends an automatic confirmation email to the lead
5. Organizes everything without manual work

📦 Tools You Can Use
You can choose:

- Google Forms or Typeform (trigger)
- Google Sheets or Zapier Tables
- Gmail
- Slack or Email notifications
- Zapier Formatter (optional but recommended)

📋 Your Tasks (Step-by-Step)
Follow these steps:

1. Create a form that collects:
    - Name
    - Email
    - Message or request
2. Trigger:
    - New form submission
3. Action 1:
    - Save the lead into a table or spreadsheet
4. Action 2:

    - Send yourself a notification
      Example: “New lead from {{Name}}”
5. Action 3:
    - Send an automatic email to the lead
      Example:
      “Thanks for contacting us. We’ll reply soon.”
6. (Optional – Advanced)
    - Use Formatter to clean or format the name
    - Add a filter to only notify for specific messages

✅ Success Criteria
Your automation is correct if:

- Every new form entry is saved automatically
- You receive a notification instantly
- The lead gets an automatic email
- Everything runs without manual work

🚀 Bonus Challenges (Optional)
If you want to level up:

- Add Slack notifications
- Add tags or categories
- Add a second Zap that follows up after 24 hours
- Create a simple dashboard using Zapier Tables or Interfaces

💡 Why This Matters
This is exactly how real businesses use Zapier:

- customer support
- lead capture
- sales systems
- CRM automation

If you can build this, you can automate 80% of repetitive work.